



Firefox 4 to feature Microsoft's Bing

Mozilla has revealed that Microsoft's Bing search engine will soon join a default part of Firefox's search bar. And, this will happen when Firefox 4 arrives. The developers' team further said that it would feature some slight changes to the list of search engines, offering, in order: Google (default), Yahoo!, Bing, Amazon, eBay and Wikipedia. Until now, tech-savvy users could install a Bing search plug-in on their own. But now, it will be easier to access the search engine by clicking on the drop-down list in the browser's built-in search box.



Skype comes to Android, but fails to impress

Despite its promising appearance, Skype's platform-wide Android app (released on October 5) failed to impress users. The application allows Android-based mobile phone users to use Skype to make phone calls using either a Wi-Fi or a mobile data connection. But unfortunately, the service is nothing but a mess of unexplained options and unreasonable restrictions. It works only over Wi-Fi and doesn't support 3G. Moreover, it does not include any video calling functionality.

Kyocera launches the Zio smartphone, based on Android

Kyocera has released its Zio smartphone, which features an Android OS and an 8.9-cm (3.5-inch) high-resolution WVGA touchscreen. The compact and lightweight phone supports CDMA2000 1.EV-DO Rev.A wireless communications, as well as Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. Zio also features a 3.2-megapixel camera as well as handy and easy-to-use widget applications such as YouTube and Google Maps. It measures 116 x 58.6 x 12.2mm and weighs 105g, making it one of the lightest, thinnest Android devices in the world, according to the company.



Samsung starts rolling out FroYo updates for Galaxy S

As promised, Samsung has started to update its flagship device, Galaxy S with the Android 2.2, a.k.a. FroYo, update. The upgrade contains a host of feature updates like a GPS fix, Adobe Flash 10.1 compatibility, pinch-to-zoom, media hub and video recording in MP4 format, among others. Ever since its launch, Samsung has sold more than 5 million Galaxy S handsets globally.

Google open sources Liquid Galaxy

Google has open sourced Liquid Galaxy, the company's Google Earth environment which is composed of eight 139.7-cm (55-inch) LCD screens. Liquid Galaxy is designed to be an immersive, surround view that covers a user's entire field of vision with images and 3D content, such as buildings, landscapes and various landmarks, from the company's Google Earth application. According to Jason Holt, software engineer, Google, Liquid Galaxy set-ups can be found in the company's offices all around the world and there is a Liquid Galaxy on display at the Tech Museum in California.

Sony Ericsson breaks ties with Symbian

Though Nokia may hope to revive its mobile phone business with Symbian^3, the latest version of its key platform, Sony Ericsson wants to focus on using the Android operating system for its smartphones. The company, which has been the biggest supporter of Symbian (besides Nokia) over the past decade, has announced that it is withdrawing support for the Symbian operating system. Sony Ericsson will also shift focus to Windows Phone 7 for its handsets.

Oracle, IBM join hands for OpenJDK project

Oracle and IBM are collaborating to allow developers and customers to build and innovate based on existing Java investments and the OpenJDK reference implementation. Specifically, the companies will collaborate in the OpenJDK project to develop an open source Java environment.

The two companies said they would make OpenJDK the primary location for Open Source Java SE development. The Java Community Process (JCP) will continue to be the primary standards body for Java specification work, and both companies will work to continue to enhance the JCP.

The collaboration will centre on the OpenJDK project, the open source implementation of the Java standard edition (Java SE) specification, the Java Language, the Java development kit (JDK) and Java SE runtime environment (JRE). Oracle and IBM will support the recently announced OpenJDK development roadmap, which accelerates the availability of Java SE across the open source community.